

**Orthodox Church of the
Resurrection of Christ
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***Today is a feast day
for all of us***—the
infirm. Today,
brothers and sisters,
we are, in a sense,
celebrating our own
Name Day—our own
special feast. Who
among us can boast
that he is strong,
courageous, able to

endure all the tribulations of this age, and capable of fulfilling all of Christ's commandments? God forbid that such a one should stand in our midst—for one could scarcely imagine a worse kind of "righteous" or "strong" man! The Apostle Paul declared: "Most gladly, therefore, I will rather boast in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me. Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in needs, in persecutions, in distresses, for Christ's sake. For when I am weak, then I am strong."

And there was but one thing of which the Apostle never deprived himself: a steadfast faith and an unwavering hope in the Savior. "For God's strength is made perfect in weakness!" The Apostle Paul declared: "Most gladly, therefore, I will rather boast in my infirmities, that the power of Christ may rest upon me. Therefore I take pleasure in infirmities, in reproaches, in needs, in persecutions, in distresses, for Christ's sake. For when I am weak, then I am strong." And there was but one thing of which the Apostle never deprived himself: a steadfast faith and an unwavering hope in the Savior. "For God's strength is made perfect in weakness!"

Let us rejoice in the fact that we, at the very least, acknowledge ourselves to be just such people! The Lord came into the world to save infirm sinners—and we are among them. It was the "strong" who crucified Jesus Christ; and the Lord permitted them this terrible, insane power—the power to crucify God Himself. Whenever we become proud and self-assured, we repeat that terrible crime of the God-fighters: the crucifixion of the Savior.

Let us, therefore, acknowledge ourselves for what we truly are. The Apostle James writes: "What is your life? It is a vapor that appears for a little time and then vanishes."

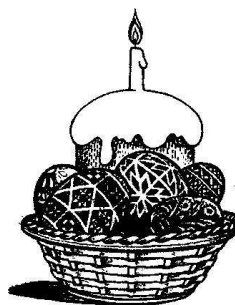
**Sunday, May 3 2026
Divine Liturgy Sundays at 9:30 AM
Confessions before Liturgy
Coffee Hour after Liturgy – bring a snack to share**

**Sunday of the Paralytic
О Расслабленном**

Yet, deep within us, something unerringly whispers that a human being is something far greater than mere vapor... Our life—yes, it is fleeting; it withers like grass beneath the scorching southern sun. Recall the words of the Psalter: the days of man "are like a flower of the field; so they flourish and fade." In the life of each one of us, there will be—time and again—moments of infirmity and falling, and of what we call spiritual paralysis. These periods may drag on for many years, much like the plight of the paralytic at the Sheep Gate Pool, whose story is recounted in the Gospel. That paralytic lay there for years, awaiting a cure. Yet he held fast to the belief that a messenger of God would surely come and heal him.

Let us only take care never to deem ourselves strong, for our true strength lies solely in Christ. The Lord—who "by death trampled down death"—can grant eternal life to us as well; He can raise us—who one day must surely lie within the grave—out of that final and eternal paralysis.

Let us not think too highly of ourselves; let us not be astonished by our own infirmities; let us not fall into despair or despondency because of them. Let us... ..sincerely, and with all our might,... to strive toward amendment, contending against the evil and sin that dwell within us. Let us firmly believe that in this, our Lord Jesus Christ will aid us. He loves us, for we are His children. The Lord does not forsake us—we who acknowledge ourselves to be infirm and who seek help from our Heavenly Father—but rather infuses us with His own invincible strength. It is by this alone that we are strong—just as by this alone were all the Apostles, Confessors, Venerable Saints, and Martyrs strong.
(Archimandrite Tikhon (Shevkunov))



**Tuesday evening 5 May 26:
Mid-Pentecost . Vespers 6:30 PM**

(Дея. 9, 32-42; Ин. 5, 1-15). "Вот, ты выздоровел; не грехи больше, чтобы не случилось с тобою чего хуже". Грех не душу только поражает, но и тело. В иных случаях это весьма очевидно; в других, хоть не так ясно, но истина остается истинною, что и болезни тела все и всегда от грехов и ради грехов. Грех совершается в душе и прямо делает ее больною; но так как жизнь тела от души, то от больной души, конечно, жизнь не здоровая. Уже то одно, что грех наводит мрак и тугу, должно неблагоприятно действовать на кровь, в которой основание здоровья телесного. Но когда припомнишь, что он отделяет от Бога - Источника жизни, и ставит человека в разлад со всеми законами, действующими и в нем самом и в природе, то еще дивиться надо, как остается живым грешник после греха. Это милость Божия, ожидающая покаяния и обращения. Следовательно, большому, прежде всякого другого дела, надо поспешить очиститься от грехов и в совести своей примириться с Богом. Этим проложится путь и благодетельному действию лекарств. Слышно, что был какой-то знаменательный врач, который не приступал к лечению, пока больной не исповедуется и не причастится св. Таин; и чем труднее была болезнь, тем он настойчивее этого требовал.

(Святитель Феофан Затворник. Мысли на каждый день года)

Нам нужен Живой Бог

Химическая формула воды может удовлетворить жажду ума, но она не в силах утолить жажду, для которой нужна сама вода.

Нам нужны не доказательства существования Бога, не идея о Боге, а Сам Бог, Живой, Любящий.

И в конце концов доказать существование Бога может только Сам Бог Своим бытием. Своим вхождением в душу человека.

At the Sheep's Gate there was a pool, which was called Bethesda, which means "house of mercy," or God's mercy: the water used to gather from a curative spring. According to the testimony of Evsevius (in the 5th century AD), the pool had 5 porches. This healing spring attracted many people with different ailments. However, this was no ordinary healing spring: it manifested its curative power only at times, when God's Angel descended and stirred up the water, and upon the water being stirred up, only the first person to immerse into the pool was cured; evidently, the water retained its

healing properties for a short time only, thereafter, losing them.

Here, by the pool, lay a paralytic who had suffered for 38 years and who had almost lost all hopes of a cure. Particularly — as he explained to the Lord — not having an assistant, he was incapable of utilizing the miraculous spring, as he didn't have the strength to move fast enough to immerse himself into the water, immediately after it was stirred. Taking pity, the Lord instantly cures the unfortunate with only His words: "Rise, take up your bed and walk." With this, the Lord showed through His saving grace, His superiority over the Old Testament methods.

However, as this was Saturday, the Jews, instead of being happy for the unfortunate individual that had suffered for so many years, or be amazed by the miracle, were annoyed because the former paralytic had the audacity to violate the tranquillity of the Sabbath, rebuked him. However, the cured paralytic, not without some effrontery, began to justify himself, stating that he is only carrying out the wishes of Him, Who healed him and Who in his eyes, had sufficient authority to release him from conforming to the rather narrow-minded regulations regarding Saturday. With traces of contempt, the Jews inquired of the former paralytic as to Who was the Person, that had the audacity to permit him to violate a public regulation?

Blessed Theophilactus notes interestingly on this: "Here is the meaning of evil! They do not ask, Who cured him, but Who ordered him to carry his bed. They are not interested in that, which brings you to amazement, but that which is censured." Although they were not certain, they most probably guessed that the Healer was none other than the hated Jesus from Nazareth, and therefore did not want to discuss the miracle. The cured paralytic could not answer them as he did not know Jesus.

Soon afterward, he most probably went to the temple in order to bring a sacrifice, in gratitude for his healing. Here, the Lord met him with significant words: "See, you have been made well. Sin no more, lest a worse thing come upon you." From these words, it can be seen that sickness overtakes a person for his sins, and the Lord warns the cured paralytic against repeating the sins, so as not to be afflicted with a greater punishment. Recognizing his Healer, he went and told the Jews about Him: not with any evil intent, but just to raise the authority of Jesus Christ. This evoked a new rage of hatred in the Jews, and they "sought to kill Him, because He had done these things on the Sabbath." (*from Explanation of the Four Gospels by Abp. Averky*)

CHRIST IS RISEN!

INDEED HIS RISEN!

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